National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Murfreesboro, TN	**Accident Number:**	NYC08CA040
Date & Time:	11/16/2007, 0850 CST	**Registration:**	N4396T
Aircraft:	Piper PA-28-140	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	2 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Instructional		

Analysis

During an instructional flight the student pilot slipped the Piper PA-28-140 in order to lose altitude while on final approach for landing. After reaching a "reasonable approach altitude" the student then realigned the airplane and continued the final approach. During the flare, the student "flared way too much," and the airplane ballooned. The instructor then "grabbed" the controls and added full power in an attempt to recover. According to the instructor, the airplane was so close to the ground at this point that it did not have time to climb out. The instructor then "chose" to touchdown in the grass to the left of the runway, substantially damaging the airplane.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The flight instructor's inadequate remedial action and failure to maintain runway alignment.

Findings

Occurrence #1: ON GROUND/WATER ENCOUNTER WITH TERRAIN/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING

Findings
1. DISTANCE/ALTITUDE - MISJUDGED - DUAL STUDENT
2. FLARE - IMPROPER - DUAL STUDENT
3. (C) REMEDIAL ACTION - INADEQUATE - PILOT IN COMMAND(CFI)
4. (C) PROPER ALIGNMENT - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND(CFI)
5. TERRAIN CONDITION - GRASS

Factual Information

Flight Instructor Information

Certificate:	Flight Instructor; Commercial	**Age:**	21, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	Right
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	Yes
Instructor Rating(s):	Airplane Single-engine	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 2 With Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	11/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	05/01/2007
Flight Time:	435 hours (Total, all aircraft), 233 hours (Total, this make and model), 370 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 69 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 22 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 2 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Student Pilot Information

Certificate:	Student	**Age:**	23, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	None	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	Yes
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 2 With Waivers/Limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	03/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	42 hours (Total, all aircraft), 42 hours (Total, this make and model), 6 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 33 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 11 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Piper	**Registration:**	N4396T
Model/Series:	PA-28-140	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	28-7225162
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	10/01/2007, 100 Hour	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2150 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	5924 Hours as of last inspection	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-360-D2A
Registered Owner:	Maxair LLC.	**Rated Power:**	160 hp
Operator:	Maxair LLC.	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	MQY, 615 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	11 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	1456 CST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	315°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	4 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	160°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.24 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	4°C / 0°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Fayettsville, TN (FYM)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	VFR
Destination:	Murfreesboro, TN (MBT)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	0800 CST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Murfreesboro Municipal Airport (MBT)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	615 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	18	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	3898 ft / 100 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Full Stop; Traffic Pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	2 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	2 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	35.877500, -86.377500

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Todd G Gunther	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	David Alderman; FAA/FSDO; Nashville, TN		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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